sysuse — Use shipped dataset

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Description

`sysuse` *filename* loads the specified Stata-format dataset that was shipped with Stata or that is stored along the ado-path. If *filename* is specified without a suffix, `.dta` is assumed.

`sysuse dir` lists the names of the datasets shipped with Stata plus any other datasets stored along the ado-path. You can also see `help dta_examples` for a list of datasets shipped with Stata.

Quick start

List example datasets installed with Stata

```
sysuse dir
```

Use `auto.dta` example dataset installed with Stata

```
sysuse auto
```

Same as above, but clear current dataset from memory first

```
sysuse auto, clear
```

Menu

File > Example datasets...

Syntax

Use example dataset installed with Stata

```
sysuse ["]filename["] [ , clear ]
```

List example Stata datasets installed with Stata

```
sysuse dir [ , all ]
```

Options

`clear` specifies that it is okay to replace the data in memory, even though the current data have not been saved to disk.

`all` specifies that all datasets be listed, even those that include an underscore (_) in their name. By default, such datasets are not listed.

Remarks and examples

Remarks are presented under the following headings:

Typical use
A note concerning shipped datasets
Using user-installed datasets
How sysuse works

Typical use

A few datasets are included with Stata and are stored in the system directories. These datasets are often used in the help files to demonstrate a certain feature.

Typing

```
. sysuse dir
```

lists the names of those datasets. One such dataset is `lifeexp.dta`. If you simply type `use lifeexp`, you will see

```
. use lifeexp
file lifeexp.dta not found
r(601);
```

Type `sysuse`, however, and the dataset is loaded:

```
. sysuse lifeexp
(Life expectancy, 1998)
```

The datasets shipped with Stata are stored in different folders (directories) so that they do not become confused with your datasets.

A note concerning shipped datasets

Not all the datasets used in the manuals are shipped with Stata. To obtain the other datasets, see [D] **webuse**.

The datasets used to demonstrate Stata are often fictional. If you want to know whether a dataset is real or fictional, and its history, load the dataset and type

```
. notes
```

A few datasets have no notes. This means that the datasets are believed to be real, but that they were created so long ago that information about their original source has been lost. Treat such datasets as if they were fictional.

Using user-installed datasets

Any datasets you have installed using `net` or `ssc` (see [R] **net** and [R] **ssc**) can be listed by typing `sysuse dir` and can be loaded using `sysuse` *filename*.

Any datasets you store in your personal ado folder (see [P] **sysdir**) are also listed by `sysuse dir` and can be loaded using `sysuse` *filename*.

How sysuse works

`sysuse` simply looks across the ado-path for `.dta` files; see [P] **sysdir**.

By default, `sysuse dir` does not list a dataset that contains an underscore (_) in its name. By convention, such datasets are used by ado-files to achieve their ends and probably are not of interest to you. If you type `sysuse dir, all`, then all datasets are listed.

Stored results

`sysuse dir` stores in the macro `r(files)` the list of dataset names.

`sysuse` *filename* stores in the macro `r(fn)` the *filename*, including the full path specification.

Also see

[D] **frames use** — Load a set of frames from disk

[D] **use** — Load Stata dataset

[D] **webuse** — Use dataset from Stata website

[P] **findfile** — Find file in path

[P] **sysdir** — Query and set system directories

[R] **net** — Install and manage community-contributed additions from the internet

[R] **ssc** — Install and uninstall packages from SSC

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